

Section 13.2 Community and tradition

Students will be required to: demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the specification; express their own responses to the issues and questions raised by the specification using reasons and evidence; evaluate alternative points of view about these issues and questions.

Key words — Bhagavad Gita, brahmin, guru, manusmriti, Sanskrit, shruti, smriti, swami, Upanishads, varna, Vedas, Vaishnavism

- The meaning and significance of the difference between smriti and shruti.
- Why the Vedas are important for Hindus.
- Why the Upanishads are important for Hindus.
- Why the Bhagavad Gita is important for Hindus.
- The priestly role and importance of the brahmins.
- The role and importance of the swami.
- The role and importance of the guru.
- The meaning and importance of the four varnas.
- How and why attitudes to caste have changed in Hinduism.
- The nature and importance of Swaminarayan.
- The nature and importance of ISKCON (International Society for Krishna Consciousness).